

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Notion hiring team,

I am applying for the Forward Deployed Architect role in San Francisco. I run the same delivery loop in my consultancy: understand how work actually happens, turn an ambiguous goal into a system design, build the workflow, and leave the customer able to operate it. I live in Emeryville, so Notion's Anchor Days are a short commute.

Your posting asks the Architect to decide what Notion should own, where it should integrate, and how it becomes a durable operating layer. That is the architecture question I want to solve. My working rule is that Notion owns the work and review surface while specialized applications retain their machinery, with APIs and automations joining the two.

Here is the evidence I would bring to customer engagements:

- **Discovery before design:** I map goals, current state, pain, stakeholders, constraints, and unknowns before proposing architecture. One recent discovery separated a tutoring company's scheduling, payment, calendar-privacy, and adoption problems into prioritized requirements.
- **Implementation and handoff:** I automated an IT MSP's pre-sales risk assessments, cut processing time 98%, then trained the team to operate and extend it.
- **Field learning into product:** In a 30-day pilot with four users, I converted observed friction into one-click generation, multiple draft options, research integration, and direct publishing.
- **Notion and AI fluency:** production Notion API integrations, OAuth Connections, MCP, n8n, agent workflows, TypeScript, Python, and Claude Code.

My relevant experience spans five years: three years of founder consulting and two-plus years building operational AI and data systems in IBM Customer Support. My Notion engagements have not yet been Fortune-scale deployments; the discovery, architecture, adoption, and handoff responsibilities are the work I already own.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to walk through a discovery record from current-state process to implementation boundary and success criteria.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker